

## **VII. What God Has Taught Me**

- A. I honour my dad through this testimony.
- B. A genuine relationship with God is essential.
  - 1. Going to church is not enough.
  - 2. We must live for Christ every day.
- C. Matthew 28:18–20
  - 1. Make disciples.
  - 2. Share the Gospel with everyone.

## **VIII. God Uses Every Season**

- A. Jeremiah 29:11 reminds me that God has a plan.
- B. Romans 8:28 reminds me God works all things for good.
  - 1. Bullying led to a new school and joy.
  - 2. Losing my dad strengthened my faith.
  - 3. My pain became part of God's purpose.
- C. God doesn't waste our pain.

## **IX. My Encouragement to You**

- A. God comforted me through every trial.
- B. 2 Corinthians 1:3–4 teaches us to comfort others.
- C. Be prepared to spend eternity with Christ.

## **X. Conclusion**

- A. God has been faithful throughout my life.
- B. Trust His plan.
- C. Philippians 4:13
  - 1. "I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me."
  - 2. Give God all the glory.

# Jacob's Preaching 1

I did not grow up in a Christian home. But I had certain influences like before bed I would say Psalms 4:8 "For I will both lay you down in peace for our lord makes me dwell in safety" Amen. In my local community we have a combined church event called Day camp (outdoors with Jesus). I went to this camp as a younger kid. And my grandparents Nanna Lord and Teddy Tom, the few times a year I went to their house we would go to their small church.

As a christian now i look back on my life and see God's hand on it all leading me to church in

2023 when I said to my dad I really want to go to church but I don't know why?

Dads grew up as a Christian so he had a good relationship with God up until his twenties when obviously life got too busy and he slowly fell away from his faith.

In the middle of 2023 I accepted Jesus into my heart. Then!

After being bullied at my local public high school for 3 years I found out my church had a school that I could go to. So 4 months after becoming a Christian God made a way for me to go to my church's school, instantly after years of being bullied and not having solid friendships made lots of friends and my grades began to improve a lot! I was all round happy again for the first time in years!

In February 2024 I was baptised in water and in the Holy Spirit with my mum. Praise God!

Then I found out my church did mission trips to Vanuatu (which is one of the poorest countries in the world and has 80 islands in the South Pacific Ocean.) So with this information I said to my dad I really want to go. After chatting to dad for a few weeks we agreed that we will go. And from that trip was one that tested my limits but also began my love for traveling and my love for the people of other countries.

In 2025 I continued to build my relationship with God, then in March of 2025 I was given the opportunity to go back to Vanuatu. This time I went with my mum and little brother and left dad at home in little old New Zealand.

In August of 2025 my dad went to Mexico where he preached in some of the world's scariest prisons where he prayed for and baptised murderers and gang members.

When he got back from Mexico we went to visit his parents, where my nanna mentioned a man named Laurie Hennessey and I was very interested in this man, so in my PJ's, I met this man who asked me whether I wanted to go to the Philippines and I said YES of course. But what I had forgotten was I had no money and I had just brought my car. So I turned to my community where I was given enough money so that I could go to the Philippines with this man. Looking back, that was another one of the best decisions I have ever made.

God doesn't waste our pain—He uses it!

I've gone through bullying, loss, and grief

God has comforted me

Now I'm literally standing in front of others sharing my story to help you.

2 Corinthians 1:3–4

"Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassion and the God of all comfort,

who comforts us in all our troubles, so that we can comfort those in any trouble with the comfort we ourselves receive from God." Because when that day comes we want to be prepared, so we can spend eternity with Him!

I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me!